

**Before the FEDERAL COMMUNICATIONS COMMISSION Washington, D.C. 20554**

In the Matter of SpaceX Application for Authority to Launch and Operate an "Orbital Data Center" in the 500 km – 2,000 km range **File No. SAT-LOA-20260108-00016**

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**CONSOLIDATED SUPPLEMENTAL PETITION TO DENY**

**I. INTRODUCTION AND VERIFICATION OF PRIOR FILING**

Petitioner William Stewart ("Petitioner") hereby submits this Consolidated Supplemental Petition to Deny regarding the application of SpaceX to operate an "Orbital Data Center" at altitudes between 500 km and 2,000 km.

**Verification of Prior Physical Filing:** Petitioner formally notifies the Commission that a comprehensive physical evidentiary package was delivered to the FCC Reference Information Center via USPS (Tracking: **9400 1361 0619 6292 9684 37**) on February 17, 2026. This electronic supplement ensures the Commission and all parties have digital access to the critical safety data contained therein while the physical records undergo processing.

**II. DISCOVERY OF SIGNIFICANT OPERATIONAL RISKS**

Since the initial filing, Petitioner has identified three major technical concerns that underscore why a waiver of standard safety protocols would be detrimental to the public interest.

**A. The "Forever Zone" and Atmospheric Persistence** Current Starlink deployments benefit from atmospheric drag at 550 km, which acts as a natural "self-cleaning" mechanism for debris. However, at the requested range of 2,000 km, atmospheric drag is negligible. Debris created at these altitudes will persist for centuries. The applicant's safety track record at lower altitudes does not translate to this high-risk environment.

**B. The Maneuver Paradox and Scalability Failure** Public data indicates that a fleet of 9,000 satellites already requires approximately 300,000 maneuvers annually to avoid collisions. Scaling this model to the requested 1,000,000 assets would create a computationally and physically unmanageable "collision noise" environment. This environment significantly increases the probability of catastrophic failure due to sheer volume.

**C. The 0.8% "Operational Tax" on Fuel Sustainability** High-frequency maneuvering carries a fuel cost estimated at 0.8% per active cycle. This constant "tax" on fuel reserves leads to premature satellite exhaustion. Once fuel is exhausted, a satellite at 2,000 km becomes a permanent, unguided hazard, as it cannot be safely de-orbited via drag.

### **III. CONCLUSION**

The risks of orbital permanence and the failure of current maneuver models to scale safely to 1,000,000 assets represent a significant threat to the long-term sustainability of Low Earth Orbit. The Commission must deny this waiver and require a full environmental and technical audit.

Respectfully submitted,

/s/ William Stewart

William Stewart

Petitioner

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Huntington, NY 11743

631-356-2599

Date: March 5, 2026

## **CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE**

I, William Stewart, hereby certify that on this 5th day of March, 2026, I served a copy of the foregoing **Consolidated Supplemental Petition to Deny** via electronic mail upon the following parties:

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Respectfully submitted,  
/s/ William Stewart  
William Stewart  
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Date: March 5, 2026